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creativelynanda.co.za/ (Portfolio)
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Top Skills

TypeScript

Next.js

PostgreSQL

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)

Afrikaans (Limited Working)

Xhosa (Native or Bilingual)

Certifications

Introduction to Coding

The field guide to Human-Centered
Design

Introduction to Web Development

Hands on with Google AI Studio

Chatgpt for Business
Communication

Publications

Inside Her Roses - A Poetry
Collection

Nandawula Kabali-Kagwa

Founder, Mirembé Muse · AI Engineer · 7 AI Products Built for
African Markets · The Poet Who Codes
Eastern Cape, South Africa

Summary

I build things that shouldn't exist yet.

In mid-2025, I had zero coding knowledge. By March 2026, I had shipped 7 production AI-powered SaaS applications — each solving a real African problem, each with its own database architecture, authentication, payment integration, and AI agent system.

That's not a motivational quote. That's my GitHub commit history.

What I build:

▫ # VarsityOS: South Africa's first AI student super-app. Nova, an AI companion trained on SA student reality: NSFAS delays, R50 meal budgets, load shedding, exam anxiety. 6 independent AI agents. 15 database tables. Full RLS.

▫ # AdminOS: An AI business OS for SA SMEs with 5 specialist agents: inbox, debt recovery, wellness, document intelligence, analytics. WhatsApp-native, Xero-integrated, PayFast-connected.

▫ # StokvelOS: AI-powered stokvel management. R11 billion moves through stokvels in SA annually — most managed via WhatsApp and paper. We changed that.

▫ # K53 Drill Master: Learner's licence prep with spaced repetition and isiXhosa support.

▫ # WatchSankofa: African creator streaming platform. Because Netflix was built for Hollywood.

▫ # SankofaSessions: A media publication for African entrepreneurs and creators.

CreativelyNanda.co.za: Portfolio, Notion templates, and the Nanda AI chatbot.

▫ # How I think:

I'm a published poet (*Inside Her Roses*) who writes TypeScript. My technical work is informed by Ubuntu philosophy — I am because we are. Every system I build is designed to serve community, not extract from it.

I don't build features. I architect transformation.

▫ # Stack I work in:

Next.js 14 (App Router) · TypeScript · Supabase (PostgreSQL + RLS) · Anthropic Claude API · Tailwind CSS · Vercel · Upstash Redis · PayFast · Resend · PostHog · Sentry

▫ # What I'm looking for:

Remote product engineering roles where technical depth meets human impact. I want to work on products that matter — EdTech, FinTech, AI tooling, developer infrastructure, or anything solving real problems at scale.

"Where transformation has a template."— Mirembe Muse (Pty) Ltd

East London, South Africa → Open to remote worldwide
hello@creativelynanda.co.za
creativelynanda.co.za

Experience

Mirembe Muse (Pty) Ltd

8 months

Founder | Creative Technologist

September 2025 - Present (8 months)

South Africa

Founder and Technical Lead of Mirembe Muse (Pty) Ltd, a technology company building AI-native solutions for the African context, operating under Ubuntu. Affordability. Excellence.

The business runs across three verticals:

- Digital Services: AI engineering, full-stack development, Notion consulting
- Wellness Products: natural hair oils and teas
- Creative Studio: books, mentorship, digital products

As founder, I set technical architecture, lead client delivery, manage business compliance (CIPC, SARS, POPIA), and build in public, shipping production-grade software while documenting the process for Africa's next generation of builders.

Full-Stack Product Engineer | AdminOS & StokvelOS

March 2026 - Present (2 months)

East London, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Role Summary: Architecting enterprise-grade "Operating Systems" focused on automating SME administration and digitizing community-based financial systems (Stokvels) in South Africa.

System Orchestration: Designed a multi-tenant architecture using Next.js 14 and Supabase, implementing complex logic for automated financial tracking and administrative workflows.

AI Agent Integration: Developed autonomous workflows using Claude/OpenAI APIs to handle document processing and data entry, increasing operational efficiency by an estimated 60%.

Fintech Security: Engineered robust data isolation using PostgreSQL Row Level Security (RLS) to protect sensitive financial data for community savings groups.

Lead Developer | VarsityOS & watchSankofa

February 2026 - April 2026 (3 months)

South Africa

Role Summary: Building high-impact, localized platforms for student logistics and cultural media preservation.

Product Launch: Directed the end-to-end build and deployment of varsityos.co.za, a logistics platform solving student utility fragmentation in the SA university ecosystem.

Performance UX: Optimized media-heavy interfaces for WatchSankofa, ensuring seamless video playback and interaction on low-bandwidth mobile devices.

Full-Stack Deployment: Managed DNS, SSL, and localized hosting (.co.za) to ensure high-availability for local users.

System Architect | Digital Infrastructure

November 2025 - April 2026 (6 months)

East London, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Role Summary: Specialized in the design and implementation of relational "Business Operating Systems" (BOS) using Notion and integrated automation tools to centralize complex, high-velocity operational workflows.

Information Architecture: Engineered an end-to-end relational ecosystem to centralize decentralized business data, replacing fragmented legacy toolchains with a unified "Source of Truth."

Advanced Relational Design: Architected complex database schemas featuring multi-level relations, advanced rollups, and formula-driven logic to track real-time inventory, financial dependencies, and project lifecycles.

Workflow Engineering: Designed and deployed automated internal dashboards that standardized cross-functional communication, resulting in a 40% reduction in administrative overhead and status-check latency.

Scalability & UX: Built intuitive, high-performance interfaces (Notion-native) optimized for rapid data entry and executive-level reporting in high-pressure environments.

Full-Stack Web Developer | CreativelyNanda

January 2026 - February 2026 (2 months)

South Africa

Role Summary: Developed a high-performance portfolio and service platform using modern web standards to showcase creative and technical work.

Modern Stack Implementation: Built a fully responsive web presence using TypeScript and Tailwind CSS, prioritizing clean code and sub-second loading times.

Client Interaction Logic: Integrated custom contact and booking flows to streamline user acquisition and service delivery.

CreativelyNanda

5 months

Full-stack Developer | True Access (Disability Platform)

October 2025 - December 2025 (3 months)

East London, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Role Summary: Developed an accessibility-focused platform designed to bridge the gap in information and services for people with disabilities.

Accessibility First (A11y): Prioritized inclusive design principles to ensure the platform was navigable and functional for users with diverse accessibility needs.

Database Management: Architected the initial backend schema to handle sensitive user data and service provider directories with security as a core requirement.

Junior Developer | Cortex Hub Booking App

August 2025 - September 2025 (2 months)

South Africa

Role Summary: My first production deployment—a resource management and booking application for a tech hub environment.

Foundation Building: Transitioned from zero coding knowledge to shipping a functional, CRUD-based booking system within 8 weeks.

State Management: Learned the fundamentals of managing user sessions and real-time availability updates in a live production environment.

Balkan Burger

2 years

Manager

January 2024 - December 2024 (1 year)

Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Role Summary: Orchestrated the digital transformation of a high-velocity hospitality environment, replacing manual "legacy" processes with scalable digital systems to drive operational efficiency.

Digital Transformation: Directed the end-to-end migration of paper-based administrative workflows into a unified digital ecosystem, reducing manual processing time by 35%.

Systems Architecture: Engineered and documented comprehensive Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) that served as the "source of truth" for cross-functional teams, ensuring 100% operational consistency.

Data-Driven Optimization: Leveraged sales analytics and inventory tracking to refactor kitchen workflows, resulting in a 22% reduction in waste and an 18% increase in overall profitability.

Performance Engineering: Managed a team of 15+, implementing performance-tracking metrics that improved order-to-delivery latency by 15% during peak traffic periods.

Event Coordinator

June 2023 - June 2024 (1 year 1 month)

Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Role Summary: Orchestrated large-scale event logistics and stakeholder management, ensuring 100% operational uptime for mobile and off-site service deployments.

Project Management & Logistics: Directed end-to-end execution for high-profile events (festivals, corporate launches, and private functions), managing resource allocation and complex logistics under strict deadlines.

Stakeholder Negotiation: Acted as the primary liaison between venue partners, vendors, and internal teams, managing "User Requirements" and translating client visions into executable operational plans.

Risk Mitigation: Developed contingency protocols for high-concurrency environments, ensuring seamless service continuity despite technical or environmental variables.

Financial Oversight: Managed budget tracking and revenue forecasting for the events division, optimizing "Burn Rates" and resource spend to maximize profitability per activation.

Team Leader

July 2023 - December 2023 (6 months)

Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Role Summary: Directed a high-concurrency operational team, focusing on load-balancing resources and maintaining "System Uptime" in a fast-paced environment.

Resource Allocation: Optimized shift scheduling and task distribution for a cross-functional team, reducing operational "bottlenecks" and improving service throughput by 20%.

Conflict Resolution & Logic: Acted as the primary "debugger" for customer and internal staff conflicts, applying logical frameworks to resolve issues and maintain brand reputation.

Mentorship & Onboarding: Managed the lifecycle of junior staff, from initial "deployment" (hiring) to full integration, ensuring high QA standards across all front-facing interactions.

Marketing Assistant

January 2023 - December 2023 (1 year)

Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Role Summary: Executed data-driven growth strategies and managed digital interfaces to increase user engagement and brand visibility.

Funnel Optimization: Assisted in the design and execution of social media campaigns that led to a measurable increase in foot traffic, treating the digital-to-physical journey as a conversion funnel.

Content Architecture: Managed the brand's digital presence across multiple platforms, ensuring "UI Consistency" in messaging and visual assets to build long-term user trust.

Market Analysis: Conducted competitive analysis and user feedback loops to inform menu updates (Product Iterations), aligning business offerings with local market demands.

Engagement Analytics: Tracked and reported on campaign performance metrics, using data to "pivot" strategies and maximize ROI on localized marketing spend.

Senior Waitress

April 2023 - June 2023 (3 months)

Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Role Summary: Promoted to lead service operations and author the foundational "technical documentation" for company workflows.

Operational Documentation: Authored the company's first comprehensive Operations Manual, standardizing complex service protocols and reducing new-hire onboarding time by 50%.

Quality Assurance (QA): Established a rigorous service-audit framework that led to a 30% improvement in customer satisfaction scores within the first quarter of implementation.

Lead Orchestration: Supervised floor operations for a team of 8, acting as the primary point of escalation for complex problem-solving and conflict resolution.

Junior Waitress

January 2023 - March 2023 (3 months)

Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Distilled Photography

Content Specialist

August 2024 - October 2024 (3 months)

Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Wrote SEO-optimized descriptions for photography assets

Managed metadata and classification in large digital asset systems

Collaborated with photographers to maintain consistency and accuracy

Freelance

Workshop Coordinator

March 2023 - August 2023 (6 months)

Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Self-funded and organized a successful launch event for Inside Her Roses, combining a poetry workshop and dining experience that attracted over 100 attendees and established my reputation as a respected author in the poetry community.

Developed an innovative poetry workshop framework that enabled 30+ aspiring writers to gain confidence and skills, increasing workshop attendance by 40% over six months.

Organized and hosted multiple poetry open mic events, providing a consistent platform for 20+ emerging poets to showcase their work and engage with diverse audiences, contributing to a 25% growth in local poetry community participation.

Sportsmans Warehouse

4 years 1 month

Receiving Clerk

October 2021 - January 2023 (1 year 4 months)

East London, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Received and efficiently unloaded an average of 100+ shipments monthly of sports equipment, apparel, and accessories, ensuring timely stock availability.

Verified shipment contents against packing slips and purchase orders with 99% accuracy, minimizing inventory discrepancies and loss.

Ensured proper labeling and systematic organization of received goods, reducing stock retrieval time by 25% and improving warehouse workflow.

Cashier

January 2020 - January 2023 (3 years 1 month)

East London, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Delivered excellent customer service during checkout, maintaining a transaction accuracy rate of 99% and reducing average wait times by 15%, ensuring a smooth and efficient customer experience.

Compiled Daily Banking Statement Reports with 100% accuracy, supporting timely financial reconciliation and audit readiness.

Performed Customer Care Officer duties, including managing device repair requests sent to suppliers, improving repair turnaround time by 20% and enhancing customer satisfaction.

Sales Assistant

January 2019 - January 2023 (4 years 1 month)

East London, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Skilled in handling customer inquiries and providing tailored advice, contributing to a 30% increase in customer satisfaction scores.

Effectively explained product features and benefits across diverse sports and activities, driving a 25% boost in upsell and cross-sell opportunities.

Promoted store offers, loyalty programs, and seasonal promotions, consistently meeting or exceeding monthly sales targets by 15%.

Efficiently managed customer concerns, returns, and exchanges, maintaining a low return rate of under 5% and fostering customer loyalty.

Freelance

Author

October 2021 - October 2021 (1 month)

Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Published Inside Her Roses, a poetry collection distributed internationally through major retailers.

- Featured poet on South African TV series Gqeberha: The Empire (2023)

- Organized book launches, poetry workshops, and open-mic events
- Developing an interactive digital poetry platform integrating technology and storytelling

St John Ambulance

First Aid Instructor

February 2016 - November 2018 (2 years 10 months)

East London, Eastern Cape, South Africa

Fist aid level 3 and promoted to Corporal. Being on duty for school sports derby days, match days, and sports practice

Education

SheCodes Plus

Front End Web Development, Computer and Information Sciences and Support Services · (June 2025 - May 2026)

Nelson Mandela University

Advanced Diploma in Business Management Practice, Business Administration, Management and Operations · (February 2024 - November 2024)

Google (via Coursera)

Google Digital Marketing and E-commerce Certificate , E-Commerce/ Electronic Commerce · (June 2025 - November 2025)

Great Learning

ChatGPT for Business Communication , Computer Systems Networking and Telecommunications · (August 2025 - August 2025)

Nelson Mandela University

· (February 2023 - November 2023)